Alder Quay Financial Services Ltd

Employee Handbook

FICTIONAL TRAINING / TEST DOCUMENT - NOT LEGAL ADVICE

Alder Quay Financial Services Ltd is invented. All staff, systems, limits, approvals and company arrangements in this pack are synthetic. No real authorisation, regulatory registration, employment entitlement or product is represented. Use only to test document retrieval and grounded answers.

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Approver: Fictional Board Policy Committee

Related documents: AQ-HR-001, AQ-HR-002, AQ-HR-003, AQ-HR-004, AQ-CMP-001, AQ-CMP-002, AQ-CMP-003, AQ-CMP-004

Contents and citation guide

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Cite document ID, version and section number. All versions in this pack are current as of the shared effective date. Change notes refer to fictional history; superseded documents are not supplied.

1. Company profile and document hierarchy

Alder Quay is a fictional UK firm with 180 employees and invented offices in London and Leeds. For the simulation it offers investment advice and discretionary portfolio management to UK retail clients; it is not a deposit-taking bank and does not itself hold client money or custody assets. This is an assumed business model, not a claim of authorisation

Signed employment terms and applicable legal protections take precedence over this handbook. Specific current policies govern their subject area. Unresolved conflicts go to People Operations or Compliance; employees must not silently choose a preferred rule.

2. Joining and employment basics

Standard full-time hours are 37.5 per week excluding unpaid breaks. Probation is six months, with documented reviews at months one, three and six. Any extension or termination follows the contract and People Operations review

Pay is monthly on the last working day; discrepancies go to Payroll within five working days where possible. Employees complete identity, role suitability, privacy and security onboarding before system access. Regulated role assessments and approvals require Compliance sign-off before relevant duties begin.

3. Conduct, inclusion and conflicts

Treat colleagues and customers respectfully. Bullying, harassment, retaliation and discrimination are prohibited. Declare outside employment, personal investment conflicts and close relationships affecting decisions before acting

Do not disclose client information to family members or use confidential information for personal dealing. Compliance determines dealing restrictions under AQ-CMP-001; this handbook does not grant trading permission. Gifts and hospitality follow AQ-HR-003 section 5.

4. Speaking up and grievances

Raise ordinary employment concerns with the manager or People Operations. If the manager is implicated, contact Head of People directly. Regulatory misconduct concerns may go directly to Compliance or the independent SpeakUp channel: speakup@alderquay.example

All addresses use the reserved .example domain and do not operate. Reports may be anonymous, though this can limit investigation. Good-faith reporting is protected from retaliation by company policy. Internal reporting does not remove applicable rights to make protected external disclosures; obtain appropriate advice on the relevant rules.

5. Performance and disciplinary process

Managers set documented objectives and provide quarterly feedback. For performance concerns, agree support, reasonable adjustments where appropriate, measurable improvement goals and review dates. Misconduct concerns require an impartial investigation and opportunity to respond

People Operations arranges any formal hearing, applicable accompaniment rights and an independent appeal. No automatic outcome follows an allegation or absence trigger. Gross misconduct examples include deliberate fraud or serious misuse of client data, but findings require a fair process and legal review.

6. Leaving, acknowledgements and contacts

Managers notify People Operations promptly of resignations and agree handover. IT disables access at the approved exit time, immediately for a high-risk exit when authorised, and records equipment return under AQ-CMP-002. Departing employees must not retain business records

Employees acknowledge this handbook and linked policies within 10 working days of joining and material updates. Contacts: people@alderquay.example, compliance@alderquay.example and security@alderquay.example. Leave, benefits, expenses and hybrid rules are maintained in AQ-HR-001 through AQ-HR-004. Version 4.2 clarifies policy precedence.